Human life depends on consumption of various materials which are made up of the resources available on earth. As there is no limit to human wants, we need infinite resources to gratify our needs and wants. But the resources are limited! Now it is upto the individual and humanity at large as to how they try to satisfy their competing needs to get fulfilled by the limited resources. It means we need to make for some choices before we utilise the scarce resources by prioritising some of our needs. In this process, some needs might never get fulfilled. At the same time there might be some needs which may be fulfilled again and again with the available resources.

Economics is the discipline which studies how the individual, a society, a government is making their prioritised choices in the process of using the scarce resources to gratify the various needs and wants of life. Making such choices is an art as well as a science. As time changes the choices change. As space changes human needs change and so modify the choices. After studying and surveying the various choices made by humanity at large in differing time and space, there developed the discipline of economics. As economics is an exercise in the *space-time continuum* and it deals with living human beings it is a very dynamic subject and should only be read in this perspective to have the real feel.

A Working Definition

It is essential to feel the subject one intends to study. The fundamental way of doing this is starting with the definition of the subject. But the definition, at times or better say most of the times becomes, very abstract, jargon-laden and technical. Such a definition might not give a proper feel and understanding of the subject to a person who does not belong to economics. Most of the students of economics face difficulty in making out a complete meaning of the definition. That is why a very *general* and *layman's* definition is needed.

Human beings in their day-to-day lives are busy doing so many things. There are different activities we are involved in throughout our lives. These activities fall under different categories.

Economics studies the economic activities of mankind. Similarly, political, social and administrative activities of mankind are studied by Political